

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 26

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 6 reminds us of how much energy we have wasted in misoriented living:

"We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self."

Last week we talked about how to use, in a healthy way, our very human gift of imagination. A healthy imagination can set us on the Believe It Path when we have a misoriented response to the ATM. We can learn to appreciate the ATM without judging others or ourselves. Regardless of appearances, talent, and money, we can create oriented outcomes that declare the glory of God.

How people feel about money and how they handle money is often a real puzzle. Just like energy, the flow of money becomes distorted and aimlessly dissipates when it passes through misoriented hands. Let's see what James says about the ATM and faith. This is Nancy's paraphrase of **James 2:1-17**.

¹My siblings, do not abuse the trust of our Lord Jesus Christ, who is committed to real glory, by showing favoritism to others because of the false glory of material appearances. ²Here is an example: If a gold-ringed man comes into your synagogue in splendid, bright clothing, but also a beggar comes in filthy clothing, ³and you gaze upon the one wearing the radiant clothes and say, "You sit here in the good place, a good place that carries with it the symbol of achieved virtue," and then you say to the beggar, "You stand over there away from me because to be associated with you is social suicide, or sit below my footstool to show that I am superior to you," ⁴are you not distinguishing the rich man from the beggar by your choices, and becoming judges using worthless and malicious calculations? ⁵Listen, my beloved siblings. Did not God choose the beggars of the world to be rich in trusting God and to be heirs of the kingdom which He promised to anyone who loves Him? ⁶But you have judged the beggar to be unworthy solely based on his poverty. Are not the rich gaining control over you and dragging you into court where people are judged by man-made laws, not by God's laws? ⁷You put the rich in a seat of

virtue, yet do they not vilify and defame the virtuous name of Jesus for which you all have been summoned as witnesses? ⁸If, however, you are fulfilling the kingdom law according to the Scripture, *Love your neighbor as yourself*, you are a doer of virtue, unlike the rich who claim virtue based on their wealth. Doing virtue looks like this: If you are giving up the good place to a rich person of real virtue because he is your neighbor in a karis relationship, you are creating more virtue and orientation. ⁹But if you are simply showing partiality based on outward appearances, you are working at misorientation and are in error, and under the kingdom law of God your choices are the evidence that you have missed your way.

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, James compares real glory with appearances. Real glory is virtuous action, whereas false glory can be cheaply attributed to others based on no action at all. That is called *partiality*—offering honor to someone who has done nothing to deserve it. We see how the ATM—appearances, talent, and money—can make us partial to those whose actions reveal no evidence of real virtue.

Let's skip down a bit in our passage.

¹⁴ “What use is it, my siblings, if someone says that he trusts God, but he makes no effort? Can that trust save him? ¹⁵ If a brother or sister is without clothing and in need of daily food, ¹⁶ and one of you says to them, ‘Go in peace, be warmed and be filled,’ and yet you do not give them what is necessary for their body, what use is that? ¹⁷ Even so trust, if we make no effort, is dead, being only words and illusions.”

James is telling us a simple truth. *Only action is action (Repeat)*, and our action reveals the quality of our faith, or trust. When we believe that we trust something or someone but refuse to act on that trust, we are living in an illusion. If we are deluded enough to trust money more than we trust God, we will feel insecure unless we have money. We will create virtue stories to justify our hoarding and will count as reality our generous intentions that never translate into substantial action. Every kind of hoarding and greed stifles the karis economy within our community. God is not telling us to give to every poor person or to every cause. He is telling us to support the community of spiritually committed brothers and sisters with whom we experience various levels of karis relationship. These are people who show by their choices that they are learning to trust God and are making real efforts to grow into the possibilities of that trust.

Our prayer might go something like this.

Lord, teach me to take real action that reveals the quality of my trust in You. (Repeat)

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are grateful for this time to heal and train together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You continue to show us the truth about ourselves. Help us serve You with our real resources and learn to trust. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and mission, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus.

Amen.